Watching Over His Shoulder

Snowden told reporters he lived a fairly open life without much secrecy. But he also admitted he feared his communications would be hacked by his old employers at the CIA and the NSA. He assumed they were watching him, trying to monitor who he communicated with online. Even with encrypted e-mails, Snowden knew how much information could be gained just from metadata: knowing who he e-mailed and when.

To protect himself and his contacts as much as possible, Snowden continued practicing strict security protocols, such as switching computers often and changing e-mail accounts. He steered clear of shops and restaurants frequented by Americans and Europeans who might know who he was. He instead shopped at out-of-the way places used by locals. When Russians would sometimes recognize him, he would smile.

Invitation to Stay

From his residence in Moscow, Snowden continued to explore his options for asylum. He approached Brazil in 2014, which was still in an uproar over a leaked document that revealed the NSA had monitored the

Copyright © 2016. ABDO Publishing Company. All rights reserved.

Edward Snowden: NSA Whistle-Blower, ABDO Publishing Company, 2016. ProQuest Ebook Central,